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Inventor(s)	Gali; Ramy R. et al.

Smart surveillance system for swimming pools

Abstract

A swimming pool monitoring system including an imaging sensor for detecting the presence of an object within a defined perimeter of the swimming pool and a computer system operatively coupled to the imaging sensor with a non-transitory computer readable medium storing a program causing the computer system to execute processing to determine when an object is moving within a field of view of the imaging sensor once detected by the imaging sensor, to determine an angle of the object relative to the imaging sensor and to determine a range of the object relative to the imaging device to include a determination of a size of object for providing an alarm when the object approaches within a predetermined distance of the pool edge.

Inventors: Gali; Ramy R. (Lake Worth, FL), Matar; Phillip E. (Tampa, FL), May; David C. (The Villages, FL)

Applicant: POOL KNIGHT, LLC (Tampa, FL)

Family ID: 77062647

Assignee: POOL KNIGHT, LLC (Tampa, FL)

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Primary Examiner: Feild; Joseph H

Assistant Examiner: Akhter; Sharmin

Attorney, Agent or Firm: Beusse Sanks, PLLC

Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a Continuation-In-Part of U.S. application Ser. No. 16/774,933 filed Jan. 28, 2020, now U.S. Pat. No. 10,964,187 issued Mar. 30, 2021, which claims the benefit of U.S. Provisional Application No. 62/798,017 filed Jan. 29, 2019, the entirety of which is incorporated by reference.

BACKGROUND

(1) Embodiments relate to a smart unauthorized object pool-perimeter breach alert system, method and computer readable medium to detect unauthorized and unknown objects breaching a perimeter of a pool.

(2) Every day, about 10 people die from unintentional drowning. Of these, it is estimated that 2 are children aged 14 or younger. Drowning ranks fifth among the leading causes of unintentional injury death in the United States. From 2005-2014, there were an average of 3,536 fatal unintentional drownings (non-boating related) annually in the United States, about 10 deaths per day. About 1 in 5 people who die from drowning are children 14 and younger. For every child who dies from drowning, another 5 receive emergency department care for non-fatal submersion injuries.

(3) More than 50% of drowning victims treated in emergency departments (EDs) require hospitalization or transfer for further care (compared with a hospitalization rate of about 6% for all unintentional injuries). These non-fatal drowning injuries can cause severe brain damage that may result in long-term disabilities such as memory problems, learning disabilities, and permanent loss of basic functioning (e.g., permanent vegetative state). If a child falls into a pool, it takes less than 2 minutes for unconsciousness to set in and 3 to 5 minutes for brain damage to begin.

(4) Some pool security safety devices employ sensors that are located right at the pool entry point to detect a drowning where emergency life-saving actions need to be taken without delay. Additionally, most pool security safety devices employ only one sensor type which in many cases is not optimal for the tracked object (baby, child, elderly, etc.) and end up producing many frustrating false positives to the end user, further delaying or worst case, negating positive life-saving actions to the drowning baby.

- (5) Other pool security safety devices use sensors that provide 3 or 4 decision data points (warm body has entered the area, something has breached pool surface sensors, etc.). Thus, it has limited data to present to the user that incurs many false positives. As a result, users have low confidence and continually diminishing confidence in these systems. These systems respond to “a potential drowning is underway.” Thus, emotion is high, and mistakes are prevalent.
- (6) A system is needed to automatically sense and calculate a moving image object's range, height and width measurement estimates. The inventors discovered that prior art approaches provide for autonomously sensing, but such approaches require moving a hand-held/mobile camera (forward-step or look-down, etc.), refocusing the camera after movement, using 2 camera lens or placing an in-image measurement reference object within the field of view. Each of these approaches is unusable for an autonomous fixed mount and fixed single lens system.
- (7) Therefore, users of swimming pools would benefit from an autonomous sensing method and system that is autonomous while the imaging device is at a fixed location where a fixed single lens may be utilized in place of a plurality of lenses based on movement of the imaging device.

SUMMARY

(8) Embodiments relate to smart unauthorized object pool-perimeter breach surveillance and alert system, method and computer system to detect and provide an alarm when an unauthorized object breaches a perimeter of a pool. In one embodiment, the system incorporates a plurality of sensor devices, sometimes referred to simply as sensors, for monitoring a perimeter around a swimming pool. Perimeter as used herein means a defined area or plurality of area zones surrounding a pool and is extended away from the pool a sufficient distance to allow a warning or alert to be generated before an approaching object, such as a small child, reaches an edge of the pool and may enter into the water in the pool. The sensors may comprise infrared detectors or cameras, video sensors or cameras, auditory sensors, olfactory sensors, and ultrasonic sensors. The sensors may be incorporated into the system in a form to create a geo-position sensor or detector. Each of the sensors is coupled, either by direct wiring or through a Bluetooth® broadcast and reception system or other suitable communication system to the computer system. The computer system operates to utilize signals from the sensors to detect and identify authorized and unauthorized objects entering into the monitored perimeter of the pool.

(9) The computer system includes conventional computer elements such as a processor for executing computer programs stored in RAM and ROM modules and in a writable mass storage media. The computer system may also be adapted for Cloud storage. To this end, the computer system includes an accessible and rewritable database for storage of biometric data related to objects likely to entering into the perimeter. The term “objects” will be understood to mean animate and inanimate objects, but in most instances is used to refer to persons or animals, it being understood that an alarm may be necessary when a small child, or a disabled person, or a dementia victim may be entering the pool area or perimeter without proper protection or permission. The database may store facial images of authorized objects that are allowed to be in the pool perimeter. The facial images can be compared to facial images stored in the database for identifying authorized persons. The computer system has conventional input apparatus to allow the database to be updated by entering new facial images or other biometric data into the database. The biometric data may include auditory data for voice recognition so that the computer system functions can be controlled by authorized persons, the term “persons” being broadly encompassed by the term “objects.”

(10) The ability to update the computer system database may be limited to certain authorized persons, sometimes identified as administrators. In addition to voice recognition, the computer system may receive input from olfactory sensors and maintain a database of known smells or odors to further help in identifying authorized or unauthorized objects entering into the pool perimeter. Olfactory biometrics may assist in identifying a crawling baby in comparison to a small dog or cat. The ultrasonic and video sensors may also determine the orientation of an object entering into the

pool perimeter, such as a standing versus crawling baby or a person who may have fallen within the perimeter. Briefly, the disclosed invention utilizes a plurality of different sensors to detect and identify objects, i.e., persons and animals, entering into a perimeter of a pool and provides an alert or alarm to responsible persons to minimize the likelihood of person or animal falling into the water within the pool and possibly drowning. The identification protocol uses different sensors to minimize false alarms so that it reduces the likelihood that the system will be disabled when the pool is being used by authorized objects, such as people or pets. As used herein, the term “object” generally refers to a living person, but may also include pets, such as cats or dogs. The term “unauthorized objects” generally includes “unknown objects.”

(11) However, an unauthorized object may include an identified baby or elderly person living in a household having a pool that is being monitored. An unknown object is used to refer to an object intruding into the pool perimeter where the object is not identified in the computer database. The system may be programmed to provide a different type of warning that distinguishes between an unauthorized object and an unknown object. The computer database has conventional input means for allowing biometric data to be entered into the database by an authorized person. For example, the database may be updated by entering new facial images, olfactory scents, or auditory sound data. Each of these biometric data is associated with a corresponding authorized or unauthorized object to allow the computer system identify more accurately objects entering the monitored perimeter of the pool so that an alarm may be inhibited when the detected object is an authorized object. Similarly, the computer system can respond to detection of an unauthorized object by identifying the object and program an appropriate alert of alarm. It may be appropriated to provide a more urgent alarm if the unauthorized object is a baby or small child than might be desirable if the unauthorized object is an elderly person approaching a shallow end of the pool. Thus, the system can adapt to different types and identities of objects and determine the level of alert that is appropriate for detected object.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) A more particular description briefly stated above will be rendered by reference to specific embodiments thereof that are illustrated in the appended drawings. Understanding that these drawings depict only typical embodiments and are not therefore to be considered to be limiting of its scope, the embodiments will be described and explained with additional specificity and detail through the use of the accompanying drawings in which:

- (2) FIG. 1A illustrates a smart unauthorized object pool-perimeter breach alert system with an unauthorized object near the perimeter of the pool in a first quadrant or sector;
- (3) FIG. 1B illustrates a smart unauthorized object pool-perimeter breach alert system with an unauthorized object near the perimeter of the pool in a fourth quadrant or sector;
- (4) FIG. 2 illustrates a block diagram of the smart object unauthorized pool-perimeter breach alert system;
- (5) FIG. 3A illustrates a block diagram of the local ambient environment condition sensors;
- (6) FIG. 3B illustrates a block diagram of geo-position sensors;
- (7) FIG. 4 illustrates a diagram of an infrared imaging sensor detecting authorized and unauthorized objects in a pool area;
- (8) FIG. 5 illustrates a graphical representation of image recognition of an unauthorized subject;
- (9) FIG. 6 shows an embodiment of a flowchart showing a method for detecting an object;
- (10) FIGS. 7A-C show an embodiment of image frames used for detecting a moving object;
- (11) FIG. 8 shows additional details of the Delta Frame;
- (12) FIG. 9 provides a view of the image with a moving object within the image;

- (13) FIG. 10 shows further details regarding a step in the method shown in FIG. 6;
- (14) FIG. 11 shows further details regarding another step in the method shown in FIG. 6;
- (15) FIG. 12 shows an embodiment of a side look view of an image viewing plan;
- (16) FIG. 13 shows an embodiment of an image viewing plane;
- (17) FIG. 14 shows the utilization of the image viewing plane in FIG. 13;
- (18) FIG. 15 shows a flat Earth measurement perspective versus lens distorted viewing perspective;
- (19) FIG. 16 illustrates a block diagram of a computer system in communication with a network;
- and
- (20) FIG. 17 illustrates a configurable sector sensing pattern.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(21) Embodiments are described herein with reference to the attached figures wherein like reference numerals are used throughout the figures to designate similar or equivalent elements. The figures are not drawn to scale and they are provided merely to illustrate aspects disclosed herein. Several disclosed aspects are described below with reference to non-limiting example applications for illustration. It should be understood that numerous specific details, relationships, and methods are set forth to provide a full understanding of the embodiments disclosed herein. One having ordinary skill in the relevant art, however, will readily recognize that the disclosed embodiments can be practiced without one or more of the specific details or with other methods. In other instances, well-known structures or operations are not shown in detail to avoid obscuring aspects disclosed herein. The embodiments are not limited by the illustrated ordering of acts or events, as some acts may occur in different orders and/or concurrently with other acts or events. Furthermore, not all illustrated acts or events are required to implement a methodology in accordance with the embodiments.

(22) Notwithstanding that the numerical ranges and parameters setting forth the broad scope are approximations, the numerical values set forth in specific non-limiting examples are reported as precisely as possible. Any numerical value, however, inherently contains certain errors necessarily resulting from the standard deviation found in their respective testing measurements. Moreover, all ranges disclosed herein are to be understood to encompass any and all sub-ranges subsumed therein. For example, a range of “less than 10” can include any and all sub-ranges between (and including) the minimum value of zero and the maximum value of 10, that is, any and all sub-ranges having a minimum value of equal to or greater than zero and a maximum value of equal to or less than 10, e.g., 1 to 4.

(23) FIG. 1A illustrates a smart unauthorized object pool-perimeter breach alert system **100** with an unauthorized object near the perimeter of the pool in a first quadrant Q-I. The quadrant may be a sector. The system **100** is configured to be installed at least in part at some location in the surrounding environment of a pool. The system **100** may be configured to detect authorized and unauthorized object near the perimeter of the pool up to 360°. In some embodiments, the installation of system **100** may only detect authorized and unauthorized object near the perimeter of the pool up to 180°, for example, because of obstructions in proximity to the pool. In other embodiments, the system **100** may be configured to detect authorized and unauthorized objects near the perimeter of the pool up to 270°.

(24) Pools can be installed a few feet from a structure such as a home, garage, and pool house, for example, with ingress and egress. In other embodiments, a pool may be installed 50-100 feet from the home or other nearest building with ingress and egress. Thus, the installation of the system **100** may be placed within the environment to capture up to 360° so that unauthorized subjects approaching the pool from any direction up to 360° can be readily detected and especially points of ingress to the perimeter of the pool.

(25) The system **100** may include a support structure **102** configured to have mounted thereon a sensor suite **105**. The sensor suite **105** may include one or more infrared imaging sensors **110**. In the illustration, three IR imaging sensors **110** are shown capturing images in sectors or quadrants

Q-I, Q-II, and Q-IV. The sensors for sector or quadrant Q-III are not shown in this illustration. In some embodiments, each IR imaging sensors **110** may have a field of view (FOV) of approximately 90°. However, for sectors smaller than 90°, the FOV may be smaller. The IR image represents a heat signature. In some embodiments, the FOV of the imaging sensors **110** may overlap with an adjacent imaging sensor **110** so that there are no blind spots in the space around the perimeter of the pool. In other embodiment, the FOV of the IR imaging sensors **110** may be 180°. Accordingly, the system **100** would require less IR imaging sensors. In other embodiments, each sector or quadrant may have more than one IR imaging sensor. The sensor suite **105** may include red, green, blue (RGB) imaging sensors **115**. The RGB image captured by the imaging sensors **115** may be used to compare some of the stored signatures of the local environment from a current image to remove those pixels of the local environment to isolate the image data of a current subject. As described herein, an image may include one or both of an RGB image data and an IR image data. The image data may include RGB image data and/or IR image data. Many high-quality security cameras are available to act as both day and night imaging sensors such as, for example, a Nest Cam Outdoor Security camera with 1080p HD night vision and 130-degree wide angle view.

(26) In some embodiments, the IR imaging sensors **110** are used during the night hours or conditions so that a heat signature of breaching objects can be detected in the dark. In some embodiments, the RGB imaging sensors **115** are used during the daylight hours since the image quality by RGB imaging sensors **115** deteriorates during low light (night time) conditions.

(27) The sensor suite **105** may include one or more auditory sensors **125** to detect ambient sounds in the environment in proximity to the pool, including voice sounds or auditory sounds of objects and ambient sounds naturally occurring. In some embodiments, auditory sensors **125** may be installed in at least one quadrant to detect incoming ambient sounds in the perimeter of the pool. In some embodiments, the auditory sensors **125** may be used to identify authorized and unauthorized subjects in the perimeter of the pool using a voice signature. The auditory sounds of a subject may include audible sounds from an unauthorized animal, such as a pet, or other unauthorized persons such as a baby, child, elderly adult, disabled or person suffering from dementia.

(28) The sensor suite **105** may include one or more olfactory sensors **127** to detect specific object emanating smells in the environment. The sensor suite **105** may include local ambient environment condition (LAEC) sensors **130**. The LAEC sensors **130** will be described in more detail in relation to FIG. 3A.

(29) The sensor suite **105** may include geo-position sensors **135** to determine a range of an unauthorized object **10A** relative to the edge of the pool or other boundaries. The range of the unauthorized object **10A** may be used in determining the timing of alerts and/or sequence of alert communications as the estimated time-of-arrival or range from the subject **10A** to zone **Z0** or the edge of the pool decreases. The geo-position sensors **135** may include, without limitation, an ultrasonic range sensor **360** (FIG. 3B).

(30) The system **100** may include a computer system (CS) **101** in communication with the sensor suite **105**. The computer system **101** will be described in more detail in relation to FIG. 6. The computer system **101** may be remote from the sensor suite **105**. The computer system **101** may be distributed such that parts of the computer system **101** are integrated with the sensor suite **105** while other parts of the computer system **101** are remote. One or more distributed parts of the computer system **101** may provide the user with user interfaces for setting up the system **100** and uploading voice signatures, face recognition signatures, object specific smell signatures and/or scene recognition signatures. The user interfaces may allow the computer system to receive alert recipient lists, mode of delivery of the alert, etc. The distributed parts of the computing system **101** may communicate with each other using wired or wireless communication modalities including, without limitation, WIFI.

(31) In FIG. 1A, by way of non-limiting example, the perimeter surrounding the pool is marked by zones **Z0**, **Z1**, **Z2**, . . . , **ZX** wherein X may be a non-zero integer. Zone **Z0** is closest to the pool and

may include the edge of the pool. Zone **Z0** may have the distance **DO** between the end of Zone **Z1** or beginning of Zone **Z0** and the edge of the pool or the end of Zone **Z0**. Zone **Z1** may have the distance **D1** between the end of Zone **Z2** or beginning of Zone **Z1** and the end of Zone **Z1**. Zone **Z2** may have the distance **D2** between the end of Zone **ZX** or beginning of Zone **Z2** and the end of Zone **Z2**. Zone **ZX** may have the distance **DX** between the beginning of Zone **ZX** and the end of Zone **ZX**.

(32) In the example, Zone **1** may surround Zone **Z0** up to 360°. The distance **D1** may be the same around Zone **Z0** or may be varied. For example, some area of **D1** may be narrower in places and/or wider in other places. Likewise, the distance **D2** may be the same around Zone **1** or may be varied. The distance **DX** may be the same around Zone **2** or previous zone or may be varied. The distances **DO**, **D1**, **D2**, . . . , **DX** may be the same or different.

(33) In FIG. **1A**, the unauthorized object **10A** is shown moving from an area outside of Zone **ZX** through Zone **ZX**, Zone **Z2**, Zone **Z1** and to Zone **Z0** wherein Zone **Z0** is immediately adjacent to the pool. An unauthorized object **10A** in Zone **Z0** may indicate an imminent pool breach. By way of non-limiting example, Zone **ZX** may be used to detect when an unauthorized object **10A** initially breaches a perimeter zone of the pool. Each zone moving closer toward the pool or Zone **Z0** may raise the alert level as each subsequent zone is breached. For example, Zone **ZX** may have the lowest alert level while Zone **Z0** has the highest alert level. Each alert level may include a different sequence of alerts, a different alert message or alert indicator, and/or a different list of alert recipients, by way of non-limiting example.

(34) Zones **ZX**, **Z2**, and **Z1** on the right side of figure are discontinued by virtue of a structure, such as wall **W**. Wall **W** is just an example of a possible structure in a pool area. Accordingly, the zones discontinued, on the side of the wall opposite the side within the pool perimeter environment, may not require ranging and/or detection of unauthorized subjects. The zones around the perimeter may include those zones which have possible ingress to the pool.

(35) By way of another example, assume that Zone **Z1** has a barrier such a fence which can be removed when the pool is in use. The fence, when deployed, may designate a No-Go-Zone where no persons should breach. The term “no persons” may include those persons without a previously stored image, sometimes referred to as unknown persons. In some embodiments, those unknown persons may still be detected, if they breach the No-Go-Zone (the area beyond the fence). Sometimes, an unauthorized object may be an unknown person not yet known to the pool owners. For example, an unknown subject may be an adult neighbor, neighborhood teens, and small children entering the perimeter of the pool without permission. The system **100** may include a list of authorized objects so that anyone detected, regardless of size, which are not on the authorized subjects list can be considered an “unauthorized object.” For example, the current facial identification database may include pool owner family members including authorized mother, father and other responsible and capable family members (teenagers). It may also include unauthorized family members that are not allowed in the pool area unattended by an authorized adult. This feature may serve to prevent drowning by persons breaching the security fence

(36) The system **100** may include selectable modes of operation which allow unidentified persons to be detected without the cause for alarm. For example, if an unknown person is accompanied by an authorized person in the perimeter of the pool, an alert may not be required.

(37) FIG. **1B** illustrates a smart unauthorized object pool-perimeter breach alert system **100** with an unauthorized object **10B** near the perimeter of the pool in a fourth sector or quadrant **Q-IV**. As described in relation to FIG. **1A**, the area represented by sector or quadrant **Q-IV** has egress to the pool. By way of non-limiting example, egress to the perimeter of the pool may be from a door located in a kitchen area through which the unauthorized object **10B** may exit to enter sector or quadrant **Q-IV**. On the other hand, egress to the perimeter of the pool may be from a door located in a laundry room through which the unauthorized object **10B** may exit to enter sector or quadrant **Q-I**.

(38) In some embodiments, the wall may represent a portion of a screen enclosure around a pool. Screen enclosures may connect to buildings to provide egress from the building into the pool area through a doorway, for example, while the enclosure blocks access along other sides surrounding the pool. Accordingly, depending on installation of system **100**, imaging and ranging functions may only require 180° of observation instead a full 360°.

(39) FIG. 2 illustrates a block diagram of the smart unauthorized object pool-perimeter breach alert system **100** of FIGS. 1A and 1B. The sensor suite **105** may include sensor types such as infrared (IR) imaging sensors **110**, RGB imaging sensors **115**, auditory sensors **125**, olfactory sensors **127**, local ambient environment condition (LAEC) sensors **130**, and geo-position sensor **135**. The suite **105** may distribute multiple sensors of some or all types up to 360°. For example, the sensor suite may include one geo-position sensor **135** configured to perform ranging up to 360°, while each sector or quadrant monitored may include one IR imaging sensor **110** and at least one geo-position sensor **135**. The sensor suite **105** may include only one set of LAEC sensors **130** since the environmental conditions would not change quadrant to quadrant.

(40) Each IR imaging sensor **110** may include a night vision mode **111** and a daylight vision mode **112**. The system **100** may include one or more processors **220**. The one or more processors **220** may be part of the computer system **101**. The processor **220** may include imaging processing functions to process both IR images and RGB images. The system **100** may include alert communicator **240** to alert at least one alert recipient **245** at an address according to an identified alert delivery mode. The alert delivery mode may include text messages, a call to a landline phone number, a call to a mobile phone number, communications using voice over Internet protocol (VOIP), and an email to an email address(s).

(41) The system **100** may include applications **207** for performing the functions herein. The applications **207** may include various data sets for access by the applications to be entered by various graphical user interfaces (GUI). For example, the applications **207** may include at least one GUI **250** for entering a subject list GUI **250** identifying those subjects considered unauthorized. In some embodiments, the objects may include both authorized and unauthorized. The object list GUI **250** may include a user interface to establish unauthorized subject face (recognition) signatures **252** and unauthorized object speech (recognition) signatures **254**. The object list GUI **250** may include a user interface to establish authorized object face (recognition) signatures **252** and authorized object speech (recognition) signatures **254**, in some embodiments.

(42) The GUI **250** may allow a user to capture face signatures **252** using the GUI **250** or select an existing picture to upload the face signature **252**. Likewise, the GUI **250** may allow the user to capture voice signatures **254** or select an existing voice signature. Thus, data representative of voice captured in the real-time ambient sounds, via the auditory sensors **125**, may be used by the speech recognition module **270** to detect and pair the captured sound to the voice signature of an authorized or unauthorized object during a measurement cycle.

(43) The range/direction estimator **275** may determine a direction of ingress of the unauthorized object using data points collected by one or more sensors of the geo-position (GP) sensors **135**. Each GP sensor **135** may provide a sensed signal to the range/direction estimator **275** at the same measurement cycle. The range/direction estimator **275** may include an ultrasonic range measurement module (not shown). The ultrasonic data points are captured by directing ultrasonic frequency waves from at least one ultrasonic ranging sensor **360** (FIG. 3B) into the perimeter of the pool.

(44) For example, each sector or quadrant may include an ultrasonic ranging sensor **360** configured to detect the return of propagated ultrasonic frequency waves. The returning ultrasonic frequency waves are measured by the range/direction estimator **275** to estimate a range of a subject within the perimeter of the pool. Other imaging data may be used in ranging.

(45) The ranging estimations may receive data from the geo-position sensors **135** to provide an estimated time of arrival based at least on one set of data points.

(46) The applications **207** may include a local scene information GUI **260**. The local scene information GUI **260** may allow a user to identify one or more boundaries and/or zones in the perimeter of the pool. The GUI **260** may be used to capture local scene information and establish boundaries or zones to establish a hierarchy of alert levels. Nonetheless, only one alert boundary may be established.

(47) The applications **207** may include a face recognition module **265** configured to process data representative of an image of a captured face **58** of the subject **57** (FIG. 5) in the proximity of the pool to determine whether the captured face **58** is recognized as a match to a face signature of an unauthorized subject. The operation of the face recognition module **265** may be described in more detail in relation to FIG. 5. The applications **207** may include a speech recognition module **270** configured to recognize a captured voice signal **58** of the subject **57** (FIG. 5) in the proximity of the pool. The system **100** may use the auditory sensors to detect voice of a subject and environmental sounds which may be extracted or filtered from a received auditory signal during a measurement cycle to isolate the voice of the subject from the ambient environmental sounds.

(48) The applications **207** may include a machine learning module **285**. The machine learning module **285** may track data points over time used for alerts to minimize false alarms. The tracked data points may be stored locally or remotely in a cloud server. The applications **207** may include an unauthorized subject image generator **290** based on the captured image data of a detected unauthorized subject at any measurement cycle or when an alert is to be generated. It can be used to detect moving image object behavior, changes to specific object behavior, behavior anomalies, etc. Separate application **207** instances may also be used to provide machine learning data from the auditory and olfactory sensors, as well as to help improve the sensors signature recognition performances.

(49) The applications **207** may include a user alert GUI **295**. The application **207** may generate an alert communication to be transmitted to an alert recipient identifying an unauthorized subject in the perimeter of the pool. The alert communication may include an image of the detected unauthorized subject via the user alert GUI **295**. The alert communicator **240** transmits, according to an alert delivery mode, a text message, user alert GUI, or email to an identified alert recipient. The alert may be sent to at least one mobile device **30A**, computing device **30B**, or other communication device set by the recipient. The alert communicator **240** may transmit an alert to a local first responder **30C**. The user alert GUI **295** may communicate images with colored annotations showing where the system **100** has detected one or more “signatures of concern” representative of unauthorized subjects in breach of the perimeter of the pool and, in some cases, a pool breach.

(50) The system **100** may be configured to generate a plurality of data points for breach alert generation. By way of non-limiting example, approximately 40 decision data points may be used to attempt to, with high levels of confidence and accuracy, alert users that an unauthorized object (“baby Jane,” “grandpa Mike”) is about to enter the pool or particular zone in a perimeter adjacent to the pool. The system **100** may leverage smart phones, call lists, HD (High Definition) images and video to give the user (alert recipient) real-time data to formulate an appropriate response once a breach is alerted. For example, a parent may rush to close and lock a pool gate before the baby gets to the pool edge or intercept the baby from its path to the pool.

(51) The system **100** uses the sensor suite **105** and analytic software that attempts to predict if a specific user specified unauthorized subject (baby, elder, puppy, etc.) is attempting to advance towards the pool area or No-Go Zone. Instead of looking at a drowning situation in-process, system **100** may perform a look-ahead process to determine at least one of a direction, range and speed of an unauthorized subject to generate an alert to try to avoid breach of the pool or pool edge. Thus, a drowning situation can be averted, such that the unauthorized subject is detected and apprehended before reaching the water. Rather than alerting the user that a drowning is underway, the system **100** attempts to predict and guide resources to block or intercept unauthorized subjects before a

drowning is underway.

(52) The system **100** uses the decision data points (i.e., approximately 40) to achieve a higher level of detail and decision-making accuracy to predict a potential pool breach condition or imminent pool breach condition is about to happen with a specific unauthorized subject (baby, etc.) in an effort to prevent drowning by the unauthorized subject. The system **100** can also detect when a pool is breached presenting a potential drowning condition. The system **100** does more than just detect something in or around the pool. The system **100** progresses up the data gathering and decision-making process to detect, determine orientation and/or direction of, track a range of, recognize and identify an unauthorized subject. The system **100** may first determine gather data points to determine if the subject entering the designated perimeter of the pool is an unauthorized subject. If the subject is determined to be other than an unauthorized subject, the data gathering process may end for that specific subject in the perimeter of the pool. By way of non-limiting example, the system **100** is configured to detect multiple subjects breaching a perimeter of a pool. Such subjects may be authorized or unauthorized.

(53) The system **100** may employ image processing techniques based on a Johnson Criteria and the “DORI” acronym. The image processing techniques may provide a 25% confidence level at the “Detection level” (D) of the image processing technique. The confidence may increase to approximately 50% when the “Orientation level” (O) in an image is examined or detected using the image processing techniques. Then the confidence level may step up to approximately a 75% level when the “Recognition level” (R) of subjects in the image is examined and detected. Additionally, the confidence level may further improve to approximately 100% when the “Identification level” (I) of the subjects in the image is examined. With nearly a 100% level of confidence in a decision to provide an alert reduces false alarms to the end-user.

(54) The system **100** uses warm body IR (Infrared) sensors **110**, geo-position sensors **135** (ultrasonic range sensor, visual (RGB) detection sensors and image processing software), auditory sensors **125**, and olfactory sensors (smell) **127**. Internet data representative of local environment information (time of day, temperature, weather conditions) may allow sensors of the sensor suite **105** to adjust to real-time local environmental conditions (e.g., day versus night, snow, etc.) to optimize captured sensor data integrity of the detected real-time signatures. The real-time signatures are used for comparison with stored signatures of unauthorized subjects.

(55) The system **100** may include a speaker **247** in the perimeter of the pool to alert those in the area. For example, while others are using the pool, an unauthorized subject may still be monitored to generate a local alert of imminent breach of the pool edge by such unauthorized subject to prevent accidental drowning.

(56) FIG. 3A illustrates a block diagram of the local ambient environment condition (LAEC) sensors **130**. The LAEC sensors **130** may include a temperature sensor **332** configured to sense the current ambient temperature of the environment associated with the scene. The LAEC sensors **130** may include a humidity sensor **334** configured to sense a quantity of humidity in the environment associated with the scene.

(57) FIG. 3B illustrates a block diagram of geo-position sensors **135**. The geo-position sensors **135** may include one or more of an ultrasonic range sensor **360** and image processing module **366**. The image processing module **366** may be shared by other sensor types. The geo-position sensors **135** may use image data from one or more RGB imaging sensors **115** for determining geo-position data points. The geo-position sensors **135** may be used in detection and identification of an orientation of subject in the perimeter of the pool, for example. A height from the ground may be determined for use in locating a face of a subject, which may be a potential unauthorized subject. The orientation may include crawling signaling a potential baby or toddler. The system **100** may detect whether the subject is crawling. The orientation may be sitting, such as in a wheelchair. An unauthorized subject may include babies, toddlers, small children and disabled or elderly persons using walking assist devices. Walking assist devices may include wheelchairs, walkers, and canes.

Subjects using walking assist devices may trip or fall in the perimeter of the pool. The detected change in orientation of unauthorized subjects with walking assist device may signal a fall in the area of the perimeter of the pool or if the pool was breached.

(58) The LAEC sensors **130** may include ambient lighting sensor **336** configured to sense a quantity of ambient light in the environment associated with the scene. The quantity of light may be a function of daylight, nighttime, dusk and/or dawn. The quantity of ambient light may be a function of natural light from the sun without the addition of supplemental light such as from electrical lighting devices in the environment. During the nighttime hours, the surrounding ambient light may be detected at a higher level with the aid of supplemental lighting. The ambient lighting may control the modes of the IR imaging sensors **110**. During low light conditions, the IR imaging sensors **110** may operate in a night vision mode **111**. In normal or daylight conditions, the IR imaging sensors **110** may operate in a daylight vision mode **112**.

(59) The LAEC sensors **130** may include weather data **338** such as sensed or detected at a remote local weather station. The LAEC sensors **130** may communicate, such as via the Internet, with the weather station to obtain current weather conditions sensed or detected by the weather station. The LAEC sensors **130** may be configured to communicate with the remote weather station to object current weather conditions. The weather conditions may be updated with the reading of the local sensors of system **100**. The weather conditions or local ambient environmental conditions may cause the performance of system **100** to be controlled such as in the presence of snow, the presence of fog, high wind conditions, extreme weather conditions, etc. For example, the presence of snow may change the image of the scene. Accordingly, the local scene recognition module **280** may vary a scene signature used in a current breach detection cycle. For example, local scene signatures may include scene signatures for snow conditions, fog conditions, and rain conditions, for example.

(60) FIG. 4 illustrates a diagram of an infrared (IR) imaging sensor **110** detecting authorized and unauthorized subjects in a pool area. The IR imaging sensor **110** may be coupled to a lens **412**. The lens **412** may be dome shaped in some embodiments. The lens **412** may include a plurality of Fresnel lens **413** arranged in a dome shape. The light passing through the lens **412** or each Fresnel lens **413** is passed to the IR image sensor **110** to capture the propagated light of the scene. Additionally, the lens **412** or each Fresnel lens **413** may be responsive to infrared (IR) wavelengths to detect a heat pattern within the scene.

(61) By way of non-limiting example, an authorized subject may include an adult **40B**. Non-authorized subjects may include, without limitation, disabled persons **40A**, children **40C**, and animals **40D**. Non-authorized subjects may be those subjects which are not capable of swimming in a pool. Some adults may not be able to swim and would also be an unauthorized subject. In some instances, animals **40D** which are known to have the capacity to swim may be an authorized subject.

(62) FIG. 5 illustrates a very simplified graphical representation of image recognition of an unauthorized subject **57**. The unauthorized subject **57** is a child. Most facial recognition algorithms use over 100 facial data measurement points and use multiple facial images of each authorized and unauthorized object. The Facial Recognition application uses Machine Learning to create an AI dataset that allows the calculation and comparison of facial signatures to provide Facial Recognition of a generic face in a video frame which then leads to Facial Identification of unique faces as members of a pool-owners family. The system **100** may be configured to compare a face (recognition) signature **252** which is associated with unauthorized subject **57**. By way of non-limiting example, the face recognition module **265** may be configured to compare stored face signature data with the captured face **58** of the subject **57** in the proximity of the pool. The system **100** may use computer vision to locate the face **58** of the subject **57** for comparing the stored face signature **252** to the instant captured face **58**. The face recognition module **265** may locate the eyes **541** and **542** on the face **58** of the subject **57** to compare the eyes of the face signature **252** with the captured image data representative of the eyes **541** and **542** of the subject **57**.

(63) The face recognition module **265** may locate the nose **544** on the face **58** of the subject **57** to compare the nose of the face signature **252** with the captured image data representative of the nose **544** of the subject **57**. The face recognition module **265** may locate the mouth **546** on the face **58** of the subject **57** to compare the mouth of the face signature **252** with the captured image data representative of the mouth **546** of the subject **57**.

(64) The face recognition module **265** may locate the cheeks and/or cheekbones **543** and **545** on the face **58** of the subject **57** to compare the cheeks and/or cheekbones of the face signature **252** with the captured image data representative of the cheeks and/or cheekbones **543** and **545** of the subject **57**. Other facial features may also be determined, such as the forehead and chin to name a few.

(65) FIGS. **6-15** display another embodiment of a method to determine a range, or distance, of an object such as, but not limited to, a moving object, from a monitoring or viewing device. In an embodiment, the monitoring device may be a camera or another imaging device or imaging sensor. As explained herein, the range is determined from a “foot” of the camera to a “foot” of the moving object. As explained further herein, once detection of the object occurs, a determination of the object's physical dimensions, such as the width and height measurements, of the object is performed. This information may be used to determine a size of the object which may help determine whether the object is an infant, child or adult. This information allows for determining if the object has entered a surveillance zone and if an alarm should be raised. The alarm may be any variety including, but not limited to, audible, tactile, or illuminated. Furthermore, the alarm subsystem may be arranged to send a message to a remote device such as, but not limited to, a smart phone, computing tablet or desktop computer. If a residence has an alarm system, an embodiment disclosed herein may be part of that alarm system.

(66) FIG. **6** shows an embodiment of a flowchart showing a method for detecting an object. As shown, the method **800** comprises imaging an area of interest with a stationary imaging device, at **810**. The method **800** next comprises detecting a moving object within the field of view of the imaging device, at **820**. The method **800** next provides for determining a range, or distance of the object from the imaging device, at **830**. The method further comprises determining a size of the object, **840**. The method **800** may also provide for determining other attributes of the moving object, at **850**, such as, but not limited to, whether arms exist on the moving object or legs (collectively limbs), whether the moving object is a human walking or crawling, etc. As disclosed further below, a computing device, typically having a graphics processing unit **620**, to find a moving object in the image frame. As used herein, “imaging device” is non-limiting as this may be an imaging sensor **110** as further disclosed herein.

(67) FIGS. **7A-C** show an embodiment of image frames used for detecting a moving object. Three frames as shown, FIG. **7A**, FIG. **7B** and FIG. **7C**. If movement is detected in Frame 1, FIG. **7A**, a box **710**, or bounding box is placed around the detected object (moving object) **700**, as the moving object continues to move, as shown in Frame 2, FIG. **7B**. Referencing the Delta Frame, FIG. **7C**, the method provides for subtracting the image in Frame 1 from the image in Frame 2, specifically the area within the box **710** in Frame 2. If movement is detected, the resulting image is a pixel representation of the object **700** showing pixels and since the object **700** is in motion, the pixels is of the object **700** in motion.

(68) FIG. **8** shows additional details of the Delta Frame. When movement is detected, with X and Y pixel coordinates of the bounding box **710** are provided in the upper left-hand corner of the image and width (W) and height (H) pixel distances are also shown that define the boundaries of the bounding box over the movement object detected. The method then uses the X, Y, W and H parameters to place the bounding box **710** over the area in the original RGB (color) video Frame 2 where the movement of an object **700** was detected.

(69) FIG. **9** provides a view of the image with a moving object **700** within the image **900**. As shown, a field of view (“FOV”) of the imaging sensor **110** is provided. Also shown is the FOV bottom or picture floor and the moving object **700**. To determine the range of the moving object

700, width and height measurement estimates may be used in combination with reference assets in the image **900**. Using trigonometric equations, the range may be determined. Trigonometric equations such as, but not limited to, those equations involving a right triangle and tangent relationship equations (sine, cosine and tangent equations) particular to the right triangle, provides a series of methods to allow to easily calculate and measure angles and distances in triangles. To understand the use of these equations, viewing planes are provided below to show how and where the trigonometric equations may be utilized.

(70) FIG. **10** shows further details regarding a step in the method shown in FIG. **6**. A height of the imaging sensor **110** may be measured from the ground (floor) plane **1010** across which the moving object **700** may traverse such as, but not limited to, walking or crawling. In the embodiment of FIG. **10**, the measurement is 57 inches.

(71) FIG. **11** shows further details regarding another step in the method shown in FIG. **6**. A numerical foundation, based on a first triangle **1100** shown, factoring in the height of the imaging sensor **110** and a vertical field of view (“FOV”) measured from the center of the sensor **110** to the FOV bottom/floor **1120** of the image **900** which is half of the FOV vertical aspect of the image **900**. Thus, as shown in FIG. **11**, the FOV vertical aspect is 48.8 degrees hence the FOV bottom/floor **1120** is 24.4 degrees.

(72) The trigonometric tangent equation $\text{Tangent } \theta = \text{Opposite Side} / \text{Adjacent Side}$ may be applied. Thus, Tangent θ for 24.4 degrees is 0.4536. As discussed above, the opposite side or camera lens (imaging sensor **110**) height in the embodiments is 57 inches.

(73) The Adjacent side (distance from camera “foot” to the FOV bottom) may be determined using right angle triangle equations as follows:

Adjacent Side $b = \text{Opposite Side } a / \tan 24.4^\circ = 57 \text{ inches} / 0.4536 = 125.7 \text{ inches}$.

(74) Thus, the camera's FOV and the Y+H GPU pixel position of the moving objects “foot” location as determined by the GPU's and measurement of the video frames may be determined where in the non-limiting example disclosed herein the distance from the camera **110** “foot” to the FOV bottom/floor **1120** is 125.7 inches.

(75) FIG. **12** shows an embodiment of a side look view of an image viewing plan. As shown, the image floor **1210** extends or ramps upward towards the image horizon **1220**. This is due to the image **900** as viewed by the camera or imaging sensor **110** and human eye optics effects. More specifically, FIG. **12** depicts the camera image **900** as stored in a memory storage device in communication or used with the GPU. With an aspect of 500×375 pixels, it can be seen that the vertical 375 pixels go from the image sky **1230** region to the image horizon **1220** and finally to the image floor **1240**.

(76) The horizons vertical pixel position is half of 375 or 187.5 pixels. Since the objective is to detect the moving object **700** in a swimming pool, the image space above the horizon is not utilized as the moving objects in that location are objects that fly (e.g., birds, planes, etc.). Therefore, the moving objects **700** of interest in the embodiments herein are moving across the image floor **1240** (pool space) and are therefore limited to the GPU vertical pixel positions of 187.5 down to vertical pixel position 375. There is a linear image space to GPU pixel position space that can be correlated to the identified moving objects' foot locations and from there, range may be determined.

(77) FIG. **13** shows an embodiment of an image viewing plane and FIG. **14** shows the utilization of the image viewing plane in FIG. **13**. In FIG. **13**, the image viewing plane **1300** is taken from a view of the camera or imaging sensor **110** looking towards the scene **700** discussed above. The image viewing plane **1300** is shown where the upper left-hand corner of the image **700** starts with numbered pixel 0 (in the left-to-right X axis) progressing to the right to numbered pixel 499 (of a 500-pixel width image). Similarly, the Y axis begins in the top left corner and extends downward, going from 0 to 374 (of a 375-pixel height image). The embodiment of the moving object **700** shown in FIG. **8** provides for parameters of X: 80, Y: 171, W: 47, and H: 89. As shown, the pixel sizing is provided. In this non-limiting example, the pixels high are 375 and the pixels wide are

500. Also shown is the floor **1240**, applicable to the embodiments herein, a horizon and sky.

(78) A range of the moving object **700** may be determined. A next step is to determine a range from the imaging device or sensor **110** to the moving object **700**. Specifically, a determination of the distance from the foot or base of the camera **110** to the foot of the moving object **700** may be made. Using the parameters listed above, adding the Y pixel coordinate to the bounding box **710**, the height pixel coordinate provides a base, or foot of the moving object **700** with respect to a GPU pixel location (in this example). Thus, using the parameters provided above, the foot of the moving object **700** is as follows:

$$Y+H=171+89=260$$

(79) Thus, the imaging sensor **110** detects the moving object **700** moving across the image viewing plane floor **1240** which exists from the horizon down to FOV bottom **1120**. In the non-limiting example provided herein, the GPU image vertical coordinates are 187 pixels down to 375 pixels. The method may be fine-tuned so that the type of movement detected is the moving object **700** walking (moving at redetermined velocity or acceleration), whether walking or crawling. Therefore, as a non-limiting example, if wind blows leaves across the floor at a velocity or acceleration outside the intended range, the leaves are not identified as a moving object.

(80) When the moving object **700** is detected by the GPU, further steps are taken to determine additional information about the moving object **700**. For example, Y+H pixel coordinates are determined to provide the moving object's floor location. In the non-limiting example discussed herein that would be from 187 to 37-pixel line location. Thus, this may be considered determining the moving object's "feet-on-floor" location within the image viewing space where feet-on-floor may be considered as the moving object's "range to target" or "measure to" point from the camera lens. To simplify the method, applying a "flat Earth" viewing plane may be used instead.

(81) FIG. 15 shows a flat Earth measurement perspective versus lens distorted viewing perspective. Having the floor viewing space, from the horizon down to the FOV bottom **1120**, there is a linear space from 187 pixels to 375 pixels that directly correlates from 0 to 24.4 degrees (half FOV angle, for example). With this information, an angle from a pixel ratio may be calculated using the following equation:

$$1((375-\text{GPU foot coordinate}/187.5))\times 24.4 \text{ degrees}$$

(82) Thus, if the GPU foot pixel location is 260, the angle is determined as follows:

$$1-((375-260)/187.5))\times 24.4=9.43 \text{ degrees}$$

(83) Applying right triangle equations as the camera height was identified above, 57 inches and with Angle A now known, 9.43 degrees, Side b range to target distance is determined, 343.19 inches or 28.6 feet from the camera lens as determined with the equation below:

$$\text{Adjacent Side } b = \text{Opposite Side } a / \tan 9.43^\circ = 57 \text{ inches} / 0.16609 = 343.19 \text{ inches or } 28.6 \text{ feet}$$

(84) This determination assumes that the image floor is a flat, level surface devoid of hills, valleys, drop-offs, etc.

(85) Next, the moving object's width (W) and height (H) are determined. From the GPU, the W and H pixel dimensions are known. From the non-limiting example disclosed herein, the width is 47 pixels and the height is 88 pixels. To determine inches per pixel, with the range measurement, the specific width and height may be determined as follows:

$$\text{Horizontal inch per pixel measurement} = (\text{Side } b(\text{Range-to-Target}) \times (\tan 62.2^\circ / 2)) / (500 \text{ pixels Wide image} / 2) = (343.19 \text{ inches} \times 0.6032) / 250 = 0.828 \text{ inches per pixel}$$

$$\text{Vertical inch per pixel measurement} = (\text{Side } b(\text{Range-to-Target}) \times (\tan 48.8^\circ / 2)) / (375 \text{ pixels Tall image} / 2) = (343.19 \text{ inches} \times 0.4536) / 187.5 = 0.830 \text{ inches per pixel.}$$

(86) Thus, with 47 pixels wide = 47×0.828 inches per pixel = 38.91 inches moving object width and with 88 pixels tall = 73.06 inches (6 feet, 1 inch) Moving Object (human) height.

(87) The inventors determined that this process accurately works for only flat and level surfaces (like pools and their pool decks). Accuracy degrades when non-flat non-level, sloping hills and valleys are introduced across the image scene. Thus, measurement estimate accuracy cannot be

guaranteed.

(88) The embodiments disclosed above using right triangle trigonometry may be used in association with other sensors/detectors disclosed herein.

(89) Computational Hardware Overview

(90) FIG. 16 illustrates a block diagram of a computer system 601 (i.e., computer system 101) in communication with a network. The block diagram of FIG. 6 illustrates a computer system 601 (i.e., computer system 101) upon which an embodiment of the invention may be implemented or employed. Computer system 601 includes a communication mechanism such as a bus 610 for passing information between other internal and external components of the computer system 601. Information is represented as physical signals of a measurable phenomenon, typically electric voltages, but including, in other embodiments, such phenomena as magnetic, electromagnetic, pressure, chemical, molecular atomic and quantum interactions. For example, north and south magnetic fields, or a zero and non-zero electric voltage, represent two states (0, 1) of a binary digit (bit). Other phenomena can represent digits of a higher base. A superposition of multiple simultaneous quantum states before measurement represents a quantum bit (qubit). A sequence of one or more digits constitutes digital data that is used to represent a number or code for a character. In some embodiments, information called analog data is represented by a near continuum of measurable values within a particular range. Computer system 601, or a portion thereof, constitutes a means for performing one or more steps of one or more methods described herein.

(91) A sequence of binary digits constitutes digital data that is used to represent a number or code for a character. A bus 610 includes many parallel conductors of information so that information is transferred quickly among devices coupled to the bus 610. One or more processors 603 for processing information are coupled with the bus 610. A processor 603 performs a set of operations on information. The set of operations include bringing information in from the bus 610 and placing information on the bus 610. The set of operations also typically include comparing two or more units of information, shifting positions of units of information, and combining two or more units of information, such as by addition or multiplication. A sequence of operations to be executed by the processor 603 constitutes computer instructions.

(92) Computer system 601 also includes a memory 604 coupled to bus 610. The memory 604, such as a random access memory (RAM) or other dynamic storage device, stores information including computer instructions. The memory 604 may also include dynamic memory which allows information stored therein to be changed by the computer system 601. RAM allows a unit of information stored at a location called a memory address to be stored and retrieved independently of information at neighboring addresses. The memory 604 is also used by the processor 603 to store temporary values during execution of computer instructions. The computer system 601 also include a read only memory (ROM) 606, non-volatile persistent storage device or static storage device coupled to the bus 610 for storing static information, including instructions, that is not changed by the computer system 601. The ROM 606 may be a secure byte-addressable memory (storage) device or a direct-access for files (DAX) memory device. The bus 610 may also have coupled thereto other storage devices including a non-volatile (persistent) storage device, such as a magnetic disk or optical disk, for storing information, including instructions, that persists even when the computer system 601 is turned off or otherwise loses power.

(93) Information, including instructions, is provided to the bus 610 for use by the processor from an external input device 612, such as a keyboard containing alphanumeric keys operated by a human user, or a sensor. A sensor detects conditions in its vicinity and transforms those detections into signals compatible with the signals used to represent information in computer system 601. Other external devices coupled to bus 610, used primarily for interacting with humans, include a display device 614, such as a cathode ray tube (CRT) or a liquid crystal display (LCD), light emitting diode (LED) displays, for presenting images, and a pointing device 616, such as a mouse or a trackball or cursor direction keys, for controlling a position of a small cursor image presented

on the display device **614** (i.e., display device **114**) and issuing commands associated with graphical elements presented on the display **614**.

(94) In the illustrated embodiment, special purpose hardware, such as an application specific integrated circuit (IC) **620**, may be coupled to bus **610**. The special purpose hardware may be configured to perform operations not performed by processor **603** quickly enough for special purposes. Examples of application specific ICs include Graphics Processing Units (GPU) **620** for generating images for display device **614**, cryptographic boards for encrypting and decrypting messages sent over a network, speech recognition, and interfaces to special external devices, such as robotic arms and medical scanning equipment that repeatedly perform some complex sequence of operations that are more efficiently implemented in hardware.

(95) Computer system **601** also includes one or more instances of a communications interface **670** coupled to bus **610**. Communication interface **670** provides a two-way communication coupling to a variety of external devices that operate with their own processors, such as printers, scanners and external disks. For example, the communication interface **670** may interface with the sensor suite **205** (FIG. 2) wherein applications **207** (FIG. 2) are configured to be stored in memory **604**, **606** and/or storage device **608** and executed by processor **603** to perform the functions described herein.

(96) In general, the computer system **601** through the communication interface **670** may be coupled with a network link **678** that is connected to a local network **680** to which a variety of external devices with their own processors are connected. In some embodiments, the local network **680** may be a private network and may include wired and/or wireless communications. For example, communication interface **670** may be a parallel port or a serial port or a universal serial bus (USB) port on a personal computer. In some embodiments, communications interface **670** is an integrated services digital network (ISDN) card or a digital subscriber line (DSL) card or a telephone modem that provides an information communication connection to a corresponding type of telephone line. In some embodiments, a communication interface **670** may be a cable modem that converts signals on bus **610** into signals for a communication connection over a coaxial cable or into optical signals for a communication connection over a fiber optic cable. As another example, communications interface **670** may be a local area network (LAN) card to provide a data communication connection to a compatible LAN, such as Ethernet. Wireless links may also be implemented. Carrier waves, such as acoustic waves and electromagnetic waves, including radio, optical and infrared waves travel through space without wires or cables. Signals include man-made variations in amplitude, frequency, phase, polarization or other physical properties of carrier waves. For wireless links, the communications interface **670** sends and receives electrical, acoustic or electromagnetic signals, including infrared and optical signals, that carry information streams, such as digital data.

Communication interfaces between one or more user interfaces (i.e., devices **613**, **614** and **616**) may communicate via communication interface **670** using BLUETOOTH, WIFI, and/or near field wireless communication modalities. Communications from computing system **601** with in-range mobile devices **30A** or computing devices **30B** may use BLUETOOTH, WIFI, and/or near field wireless communication modalities. Distributed components of the computing system **101** may communicate via BLUETOOTH, WIFI, and/or near field wireless communication modalities. The term computer-readable medium is used herein to refer to any medium that participates in providing information to processor **603**, including instructions for execution. Such a medium may take many forms, including, but not limited to, non-volatile media, volatile media and transmission media. Non-volatile media include, for example, optical or magnetic disks, such as storage device. Volatile media include, for example, dynamic memory **604**. Transmission media include, for example, coaxial cables, copper wire, fiber optic cables, and waves that travel through space without wires or cables, such as acoustic waves and electromagnetic waves, including radio, optical and infrared waves. The term computer-readable storage medium is used herein to refer to any medium that participates in providing information to processor **603**, except for transmission media.

(97) Common forms of computer-readable media include, for example, a floppy disk, a flexible

disk, a hard disk, a magnetic tape, or any other magnetic medium, a compact disk ROM (CD-ROM), a digital video disk (DVD) or any other optical medium, punch cards, paper tape, or any other physical medium with patterns of holes, a RAM, a programmable ROM (PROM), an erasable PROM (EPROM), a FLASH-EPROM, or any other memory chip or cartridge, a carrier wave, or any other medium from which a computer can read. The term non-transitory computer-readable storage medium is used herein to refer to any medium that participates in providing information to processor **603**, except for carrier waves and other signals.

(98) Logic encoded in one or more tangible media includes one or both of processor instructions on a computer-readable storage media and special purpose hardware, such as ASIC **620**.

(99) Network link **678** typically provides information communication through one or more networks to other devices that use or process the information. For example, network link **678** may provide a connection through a private or local network **680** to a host computer **682**, such as a secure host computer. For example, in some embodiments, the pilot may be located at the host computer **682**. Thus, the user interfaces referenced in FIG. **6**, may be located with the host computer **682**. In some embodiments, the computer system **601** may be positioned with the sensor suite **105** while the host computer **682** is a remote from the sensor suite. The computer system **601** may be located on support structure **102**. The host computer **682** may be located within a building or residence. The host computer **682** and the computer system **601** may be configured as a distributed embodiment of computing system **101**.

(100) In some embodiments, the computer system **601** may connect to equipment **684** operated by an Internet Service Provider (ISP) or Intranet Service Provider. ISP equipment **684** in turn provides data communication services through the public, world-wide packet-switching communication network of networks now commonly referred to as the Internet **690** or alternately over an Intranet. The computing system **101** may access local environmental data over the Internet **690**.

(101) A computer called a server **692** connected to the Internet or Intranet provides a service in response to information received over the Internet or Intranet. For example, server **692** provides information representing video data for presentation at display **614** or the server may receive information representing video data for display at a location remote from the system **100** (FIGS. **1A** and **1B**).

(102) The invention is related to the use of computer system **601** for implementing the techniques described herein. According to one embodiment of the invention, those techniques are performed by computer system **601** in response to at least one processor **603** executing one or more sequences of one or more instructions contained in memory **604** to form a computer program product. Such instructions, also called software and program code, may be read into memory **604** from another computer-readable medium such as storage device **608**. Execution of the sequences of instructions contained in memory **604** causes processor **603** to perform the method and functions described herein. In alternative embodiments, hardware, such as application specific integrated circuit **620**, may be used in place of or in combination with software to implement the invention. Thus, embodiments of the invention are not limited to any specific combination of hardware and software.

(103) Computer program code for carrying out operations described above may be written in a variety of programming languages, including but not limited to a high-level programming language, such as without limitation, Python, C or C++, for development convenience. In addition, computer program code for carrying out operations of embodiments described herein may also be written in other programming languages, such as, but not limited to, interpreted languages. The program code may include hardware description language (HDL) or very high-speed integrated circuit (VHSIC) hardware description language, such as for firmware programming. Some modules or routines may be written in assembly language or even micro-code to enhance performance and/or memory usage. It will be further appreciated that the functionality of any or all of the program modules may also be implemented using discrete hardware components, one or more

application specific integrated circuits (ASICs), or a programmed Digital Signal Processor (DSP) or microcontroller. A code in which a program of the embodiments is described can be included as a firmware in a RAM, a ROM and a flash memory. Otherwise, the code can be stored in a non-transitory, tangible computer-readable storage medium such as a magnetic tape, a flexible disc, a hard disc, a compact disc, a photo-magnetic disc, a digital versatile disc (DVD) or the like.

(104) The signals transmitted over network link **678** and other networks through communications interface **670**, carry information to and from computer system **601**. Computer system **601** can send and receive information, including program code, through the networks **680**, **690** among others, through network link **678** and communications interface **670**. In an example using the Internet **690**, a server **692** transmits program code for a particular application, requested by a message sent from computer system **601**, through Internet **690**, ISP equipment **684**, local network **680** and communications interface **670**. The received code may be executed by processor **603** as it is received or may be stored in storage device **608** or other non-volatile storage for later execution, or both. In this manner, computer system **601** may obtain application program code in the form of a signal on a carrier wave. The host computer **682** may control the computing system **601** in some instances.

(105) Various forms of computer readable media may be involved in carrying one or more sequence of instructions or data or both to processor **603** for execution. For example, instructions and data may initially be carried on a magnetic disk of a remote computer such as host computer **682**. The remote computer loads the instructions and data into its dynamic memory and sends the instructions and data over a telephone line using a modem. A modem local to the computer system **601** receives the instructions and data on a telephone line and uses an infra-red transmitter to convert the instructions and data to a signal on an infra-red a carrier wave serving as the network link **678**. An infrared detector serving as communications interface **670** receives the instructions and data carried in the infrared signal and places information representing the instructions and data onto bus **610**. Bus **610** carries the information to memory **604** from which processor **603** retrieves and executes the instructions using some of the data sent with the instructions. The instructions and data received in memory **604** may optionally be stored on storage device **608**, either before or after execution by the processor **603**.

(106) The memory **604** may have stored thereon applications **207** (FIG. 2) implemented as software or computer instructions. The applications when executed by the processor **603** may perform one or more functions as described herein. In FIG. 2, a dedicated processor **220** may be provided for processing the captured images by the IR image sensors **110**.

(107) FIG. 17 illustrates a configurable sector sensing pattern **700**. A sector may be a quadrant in some examples. However, for systems **100** which monitor areas less than 360°, the monitored may be sectorized into adjacent sectors. In the pattern **700**, area **705** may be the FOV of a passive IR imaging sensor **110**. In the pattern **700**, area **710** may be the FOV of a Pixy RGB imaging sensor or camera. In the pattern **700**, area **720** may be the FOV of a NoIR imaging sensor or camera. In the pattern **700**, area **730** may be the FOV of the ultrasonic ranging sensor **360**. In some embodiments, the system **100** may use different FOVs than those shown in FIG. 17.

(108) The system **100** may include lighting such as flood lighting or IR LEDS for imaging at night.

(109) The terminology used herein is for the purpose of describing particular embodiments only and is not intended to be limiting. As used herein, the singular forms “a,” “an,” and “the” are intended to include the plural forms as well, unless the context clearly indicates otherwise. Furthermore, to the extent that the terms “including,” “includes,” “having,” “has,” “with,” or variants thereof are used in either the detailed description and/or the claims, such terms are intended to be inclusive in a manner similar to the term “comprising.” Moreover, unless specifically stated, any use of the terms first, second, etc., does not denote any order or importance, but rather the terms first, second, etc., are used to distinguish one element from another.

(110) Unless otherwise defined, all terms (including technical and scientific terms) used herein

have the same meaning as commonly understood by one of ordinary skill in the art to which embodiments of the invention belongs. It will be further understood that terms, such as those defined in commonly used dictionaries, should be interpreted as having a meaning that is consistent with their meaning in the context of the relevant art and will not be interpreted in an idealized or overly formal sense unless expressly so defined herein.

(111) While various disclosed embodiments have been described above, it should be understood that they have been presented by way of example only, and not limitation. Numerous changes, omissions and/or additions to the subject matter disclosed herein can be made in accordance with the embodiments disclosed herein without departing from the spirit or scope of the embodiments. Also, equivalents may be substituted for elements thereof without departing from the spirit and scope of the embodiments. In addition, while a particular feature may have been disclosed with respect to only one of several implementations, such feature may be combined with one or more other features of the other implementations as may be desired and advantageous for any given or particular application. Furthermore, many modifications may be made to adapt a particular situation or material to the teachings of the embodiments without departing from the scope thereof.

(112) Further, the purpose of the foregoing Abstract is to enable the public generally and especially the scientists, engineers and practitioners in the relevant art(s) who are not familiar with patent or legal terms or phraseology, to determine quickly from a cursory inspection the nature and essence of this technical disclosure. The Abstract is not intended to be limiting as to the scope of the present disclosure in any way.

(113) Therefore, the breadth and scope of the subject matter provided herein should not be limited by any of the above explicitly described embodiments. Rather, the scope of the embodiments should be defined in accordance with the following claims and their equivalents.

Claims

1. A swimming pool monitoring system comprising: an imaging sensor suite for detecting the presence of an object within a defined perimeter of the swimming pool wherein the imaging sensor suite comprises at least one infrared imaging sensor and at least one red, green, blue (RGB) imaging sensor; at least one local ambient environment condition sensor to sense a quantity of ambient light in an environment of the swimming pool being monitored by the imaging sensor suite to determine at least one of: a mode for the at least one infrared imaging sensor to operate and whether to use the at least one RGB imaging sensor; a computer system operatively coupled to the imaging sensor suite with a non-transitory computer readable medium storing a program causing the computer system to execute processing to determine when an object is moving within a field of view of the imaging sensor suite once detected by the imaging sensor suite, to determine an angle of the object relative to the imaging sensor suite and to determine a range of the object relative to the imaging sensor suite to include a determination of a size of the object for providing an alarm when the object approaches within a predetermined distance of an edge of the swimming pool; and a plurality of sensor systems comprising at least an olfactory sensor coupled to the computer system, wherein the computer system further comprises a data storage device including a database of olfactory signatures associated with authorized objects for comparison to olfactory signatures detected by the olfactory sensor, the computer system providing an alarm in response to unauthorized signatures.

2. The swimming pool monitoring system of claim 1, wherein to determine the range of the object, a field of view at a bottom of an image frame taken by the imaging sensor suite is determined with right triangle trigonometric equations.

3. The swimming pool monitoring system of claim 1, wherein the plurality of sensor systems further comprises an auditory sensor for detecting sounds within the perimeter of the swimming pool and the computer system includes a voice identification system for identifying authorized

voices within the swimming pool perimeter and responding to commands from the authorized voices.

4. The swimming pool monitoring sensor of claim 1, further comprising an ultrasonic range sensor for determining a range of a live object from the edge of the swimming pool.
5. The swimming pool monitoring system of claim 1, wherein the computer system inhibits the alarm if an authorized live object is in juxtaposition with an unauthorized live object.
6. The swimming pool monitoring system of claim 1, wherein the computer system includes a data input function coupled to the imaging sensor suite for enabling selected captured images to be stored in the data storage whereby a plurality of predetermined images of objects may be updated for additional authorized and unauthorized objects.
7. The swimming pool monitoring system of claim 1, wherein the local ambient environment condition sensor is a sensor suite comprising an ambient lighting sensor and at least one of a temperature sensor, a humidity sensor, and a weather detection sensor.
8. The swimming pool monitoring system of claim 1, wherein the at least one infrared imaging sensor is coupled to at least one lens and wherein the at least one lens comprises a dome shape.
9. The swimming pool monitoring system of claim 1, wherein the at least one infrared imaging sensor is coupled to at least one lens and wherein the at least one lens comprises a Fresnel lens.
10. The swimming pool monitoring system of claim 9, wherein the at least one lens comprises a plurality of Fresnel lenses arranged in a dome shape.
11. A swimming pool monitoring system comprising: an imaging sensor suite, with at least one infrared imaging sensor and at least one red, green, blue (RGB) imaging sensor, with a known distance to a base surface; at least one local ambient environment condition sensor to sense a quantity of ambient light in an environment of the swimming pool being monitored by the imaging sensor suite to determine at least one of: a mode for the at least one infrared imaging sensor to operate and whether to use the at least one RGB imaging sensor; a computer system with a non-transitory computer readable medium storing a program causing the computer system to execute processes to receive image frames from the imaging sensor suite, to detect an object within a field of view of the imaging sensor suite when comparing image frames at a horizon of each image frame to a floor of each image frame, to determine a range of the object from the imaging sensor suite, and to determine a width and height of the object with right triangle trigonometric equations; an alarm system in communication with the computer system to sound at least one of an audible, visual, and tactile alarm emitting from at least one of the computer system and a remote device when determined that the object is entering into a predetermined perimeter area around the swimming pool relative to the imaging sensor suite; and a plurality of sensor systems comprising at least an olfactory sensor coupled to the computer system, wherein the computer system further comprises a data storage device including a database of olfactory signatures associated with authorized objects for comparison to olfactory signatures detected by the olfactory sensor, the computer system or the remote device providing an alarm in response to unauthorized signatures.
12. The swimming pool monitoring system of claim 11, wherein the non-transitory computer readable medium storing the program further causes the computer system to determine at least one of whether the object has limbs and whether the object is at least one of walking and crawling.
13. The swimming pool monitoring system of claim 12, wherein to determine whether the object is at least one of walking and crawling is based on the object moving at at least one of a predetermined velocity and a predetermined acceleration.
14. A computerized method to monitor a swimming pool for a moving object, the computerized method comprises a computer system comprising a non-transitory computer readable medium storing a program causing the computer system to execute processes to image an area of interest with a stationary imaging sensor suite wherein to image the area is determined by information from a sensor which is used to select a type of imaging sensor of the imaging sensor suite to use, wherein the imaging sensor suite comprises at least one infrared imaging sensor and at least one

red, green, blue (RGB) imaging sensor; detect a moving object within the field of view of the imaging sensor suite; and determine a range of the object relative to the imaging sensor suite utilizing an angle of the object from the imaging sensor suite and a position of the imaging sensor suite relative to a base, wherein a plurality of sensor systems comprising at least an olfactory sensor is coupled to the computer system, wherein the computer system further comprises a data storage device including a database of olfactory signatures associated with authorized objects for comparison to olfactory signatures detected by the olfactory sensor, wherein the non-transitory computer readable medium storing a program causing the computer system to execute processes to provide an alarm in response to unauthorized signatures.

15. The computerized method of claim 14, further comprising the non-transitory computer readable medium storing a program causing the computer system to execute processes to determine the range of the object, a field of view at a bottom of an image frame taken by the imaging sensor suite is determined with right triangle trigonometric equations.

16. The computerized method of claim 14, further comprising the non-transitory computer readable medium storing a program causing the computer system to execute processes to compare image frames taken by the imaging sensor suite at a horizon of each image frame to a floor of each image frame to determine the range of the object from the imaging sensor suite, and to determine a width and height of the object with right triangle trigonometric equations.
